

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Scenario 02

Who can see the Copilot Dashboard & its reports — and why two colleagues on the same licence differ

TYPICALLY REPORTED BY

A user whose colleague (same team, similar licence) sees nothing or a permission-denied page — or an admin asking “who is *supposed* to see this, and how do I grant or restrict it?”

SURFACES INVOLVED

`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft`, M365 Admin Center (VFAM), Entra ID

ROLES TOUCHED

Global Admin, Insights Admin, AI Admin, AutoCxO leaders, Delegated users, People-managers

VERSION

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Quick answer

The **Reports** surface has *no* permission model of its own — it only shows reports to people who *already* have Copilot Dashboard access. That access comes from **three buckets**, with a **VFAM gate** sitting on top that can block any of them. Crucially, most “why can’t my colleague see it?” cases are **not a misconfiguration** — the colleague is an individual contributor who was never meant to see team or company reports.

The access model — three buckets + one gate

Bucket	Who gets in this way	Mechanism
1. Automatic by who you are	• Tenant admins • Senior leaders (AutoCxO) • People-managers	• Global / Insights / AI Administration • Auto-identified from the org hierarchy • Manager Settings "Grant manager access"
2. Granted someone gave it to you	Anyone a leader or admin shares with	Delegation (max 75, no cascading)
3. Licensed baseline the price of entry	Every user in bucket 1 or 2 must <i>a/so</i> be licensed	Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement
Gate: VFAM sits on top, can block any bucket	Any user or group	Viva Feature Access Management

The whole model reduces to four questions: **Am I in bucket 1 or 2? Am I licensed (bucket 3)? Is a VFAM gate blocking me?** Every variant of “who can see this” — including “why me but not my colleague” — is answered by those four.

The most likely answer is “working as designed”

Before hunting for a broken setting: if your colleague is an **individual contributor** (no direct reports) and isn’t an admin or a delegate, they are *correctly* seeing nothing. The Copilot Dashboard reports on a *group* — an IC has no team to report on. Only treat this as a fault once you’ve confirmed the colleague genuinely *should* qualify via bucket 1 (automatic) or bucket 2 (delegation).

30-second diagnosis

1. **Should the colleague see it at all?** If they're an IC with no direct reports, no admin role, and no delegation — **stop: this is working as designed.** Nothing to fix.
2. **Which bucket grants *your* access?** Check `myaccount.microsoft.com` → *My roles* (admin), whether you're a people-manager (automatic), or whether a leader delegated to you (granted). That tells you exactly what the colleague is missing.
3. **Colleague is a manager but sees nothing?** Confirm Manager Settings is ON
(`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Admin** → **Manager settings** → "Grant managers scoped access"), their team meets the minimum team size (default 10, floor 5, manager counts), and their `Manager` attribute is populated.
4. **Should qualify but still can't load the surface?** Check for a **VFAM gate** blocking their group, then confirm their Viva Insights / Copilot licence.

Causes ranked by likelihood

#	Cause	Why it happens
1	The colleague is an IC — not a manager, admin, or delegate. <i>Working as designed.</i>	The Copilot Dashboard
2	You hold an admin role (bucket 1); the colleague does not.	Global Administrator, li
3	Manager Settings is OFF tenant-wide.	If the Insights Admin h
4	The colleague's team is below the minimum team size.	To protect individual p
5	The colleague's Manager attribute (or manager hierarchy) isn't populated.	Manager access and A
6	You received a delegation (bucket 2); the colleague did not.	A leader or admin can
7	A VFAM gate blocks the colleague's web-app or Copilot Dashboard access.	Viva Feature Access M
8	The colleague lacks a Viva Insights / Copilot licence (bucket 3).	Even with the right rol

Most common misdiagnosis

This is usually escalated as “the same licence behaves differently for two people — it must be a bug.” In practice the two users almost always differ on **(1) manager / admin status** — and very often the colleague is simply an IC seeing the surface *correctly* empty. Identical licences do *not* imply identical dashboard access — the licence is necessary but never sufficient.

Surface vs. scope — keep these separate

Two different questions are easy to conflate:

- **Does the dashboard / Reports surface appear at all?** → governed by your bucket (admin role, AutoCxO, manager access, or delegation), your licence, and the VFAM gate.
- **Does a *manager* see *team-level* data within it?** → governed by Manager Settings + manager hierarchy + minimum team size.

Diagnose which question you're actually answering before chasing a fix.

Worked example — the executive sponsor who isn't a manager

This case comes up constantly, so it's worth walking through end-to-end because the intuitive answer is the *wrong* one.

The situation

James is the executive sponsor of the organisation's Copilot rollout. He needs the org-wide **adoption report** to track the programme. He is *not* a people-manager — he has no direct reports — and he holds no admin role. The instinctive move is "he's an exec, just give him *manager* access." That doesn't work, and it's worth understanding why.

Why "manager" is the wrong lever. In Viva Insights, "*manager*" is not a statement about seniority or importance — it is a literal test of whether the person has **direct or indirect reports**, established by the `PersonId` / `ManagerId` hierarchy. You cannot enable someone as a manager who has nobody reporting to them, no matter how senior they are. And even if James *did* have a small team, manager access would only show **that team's** adoption — not the **company-wide** view an executive sponsor actually needs.

The correct lever is delegation (bucket 2). A non-manager reaches the dashboard exactly one of these ways: automatic senior-leader identification (only if Entra ID places them at the top of the hierarchy — not James), an admin/analyst role (over-privileged for a read-only sponsor), Global Admin (far too much), or **delegation**. Delegation is the right answer twice over: it is the *only* mechanism open to a non-manager, *and* it is the only one that can carry a "**Your company**" scope — the org-wide adoption picture James is asking for.

Step	Action
1	Identify a delegator who already has company-level access — a senior leader with automatic access, or a Glc
2	That leader opens the Copilot Dashboard → Settings → Delegation → Add delegates , adds James, and assi
3	Confirm James holds a Viva Insights / Copilot licence (bucket 3 — necessary even for delegates).
4	Check no VFAM gate blocks James's group from the Viva Insights web app / Copilot Dashboard.
5	James opens the Viva Insights web app → Reports and sees the org-wide adoption report under the delegati

Delegation caveats to set expectations

- A delegate sees the surface as *the delegating leader* — a banner shows whose insights they're viewing.
- Delegation is capped at **75 delegates** per leader and **cannot cascade** (James can't re-delegate).
- If the delegating leader loses their own access (e.g. leaves the org), **James's access is revoked too** — so prefer a stable senior leader or a Global Admin as the delegator.

This matches Microsoft Learn exactly: the Copilot Analytics reports prerequisites list automatic access, *delegate access*, Insights Analyst, or Global Admin — with no “promote a non-manager to manager” path — and the delegate-access guidance confirms a company-scoped delegation is how a non-manager gets the org-wide view.

Deliberately restricting access (the inverse problem)

The harder, higher-stakes version of this question is the reverse: **“How do I make sure a particular leader or group *cannot* see the dashboard, even though their role or hierarchy would normally grant it?”** This is the everyday reality in regulated, multi-agency, or shared-tenant deployments where one agency’s leaders must not see another’s data.

Buckets 1–3 are mostly *automatic* — you can’t easily stop the platform from auto-identifying a senior leader (AutoCxO) or a people-manager. The **VFAM gate is the supported lever for removing access**:

Goal	How
Block a specific set of users from the dashboard	Create a group-scoped VFAM policy that turns the Copilot Dash
Let agency managers see <i>only</i> their own agency	Combine the VFAM block above with partition-based isolation so t
Confirm a block actually took effect	Have a test user in the blocked group sign out / in and load analy

Use group-scoped policies, never “Everyone”

The most common multi-agency mistake is blocking the Copilot Dashboard at the “Everyone” level to lock down agency users — which also blocks senior executives and central admins who are supposed to see tenant-wide adoption. Always target a dedicated Entra group (e.g. `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard`). See the Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture for the full group-scoped lockdown pattern.

What “done” looks like

- You can name *which bucket* grants **your** access — automatic (admin role / AutoCxO / manager access), granted (delegation), plus a valid licence and no VFAM gate.
- You’ve confirmed the colleague either matches *no* bucket — in which case it’s **correct by design** (most often an IC with no team) — or you’ve found the single missing, fixable item (enable Manager Settings, populate the `Manager` attribute, add a delegation, or lift a VFAM block).
- If the goal was the *inverse* — restricting access — the right users are blocked via a **group-scoped** VFAM policy (never “Everyone”), verified by a test user in the blocked group.

Related

- [Troubleshooting Scenarios catalogue](#) — browse all scenarios.
 - [Troubleshooting Guide](#) — symptom-tables for single-surface lookups.
 - [Dashboard Guide](#) — access scopes, delegation, and the Reports surface.
 - [Admin Setup Guide](#) — role assignment and Manager Settings step.
 - [Privacy Configuration Guide](#) — minimum team size vs. minimum group size.
 - [Multi-Agency Isolation Architecture](#) — group-scoped VFAM lockdown and partition-based data isolation.
 - [FAQ](#) — common access questions.
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